CHAPTER 8

# 2008

The Proteas enjoyed almost unimagined success during 2008, drawing a Test series against India in India, defeating England in England and then overcoming Australia in Australia.

Some observers may have been slow to praise a young squad, continuing to portray us as hard-working grafters lacking flair and dare, but the fact is we produced plenty of great cricket in a great year. Within the space of 12 months, this talented and happy group played 14 Test matches, winning 11, drawing two and losing one, and played 19 limited-overs internationals, winning 14, drawing one and losing four.

The team that started the Test against the West Indies at Newlands on 2 January 2008 was Smith, McKenzie, Amla, Kallis, Prince, De Villiers, Boucher, Harris, Nel, Steyn and Ntini.

The team that started the Test against Australia at the Melbourne Cricket Ground on 26 December 2008 was Smith, McKenzie, Amla, Kallis, De Villiers, Duminy, Boucher, Morkel, Harris, Steyn and Ntini.

Success led to confidence, which led to stability, which led to more success, which led to more confidence, which led to more stability, which led to more success; and so the upward spiral continued.

It was a memorable year packed with memorable days.